

2.6.2.1 Pixels

Pixel measurements give designers the most control over their layouts. It is the closest relative measurement to absolute measurements. Hence it is the most consistent unit of measurement; pixels are most commonly used for declaring the margin, padding, borders, height, and width of elements and can be successfully combined with other relative measurements for all kinds of layout requirements.

Pixels are not, however, the best option for sizing text, text sized with pixels will ignore user preferences, and so if a user has set his or her browser to always show text at 20 pixels, this will often be overridden by your pixel-based declarations.

2.6.2.2 Percentage

The percentage measurement provides a lot of flexibility. Percentage values are always relative to another value, such as a width or height declared in the parent element. In other words, a percentage can only be declared in relation to a previously defined size, within the parent element, or is based on the width of the browser window. Percentage is an integral ingredient of liquid designs where pages and their elements stretch to fit the browser window.

But some caution is necessary when it comes to percentage values, where inheritance causes problems. While pixels and ems retain some amount of control, the results of percentage values can end up very different to what is expected. When calculated by the browser, the layouts and elements can be misplaced or shunted underneath each other.

In the following example, the percentage value is given for line-height, used to control the distance between the lines of text, and relates directly to the font-size value within the rule. In this case, line-height will be applied to the text as a pixel value that is 120 per cent of 10px, which gives a line height of 12px.

```
/* Define default paragraph values */  
p {  
  font-size:10px;  
  line-height:120%;  
}
```

2.6.2.3 Ems

The em is the most misunderstood unit of relative measurement in CSS. But it is, by far, the most flexible and ideal mode of measurement in designing,